accountabilitylab NEPAL

GOVERNANCE WEEKLY ANALYTICAL REPORT

10/16/2025

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INTRODUCTION

The Governance Weekly is an essential analytical publication that systematically tracks and synthesizes Nepal's current affairs related to governance. This update is produced through the rigorous monitoring and mining of media and real sources, allowing us to capture "hot news" and identify core issues dominating the national discourse from the perspective of accountability.

Its primary purpose is to sensitize communities, stakeholders, and policymakers by providing data-backed insights into the frequency and nature of governance challenges, such as Irregularity, Corruption, Economic management, and Political stability. By consistently analyzing these thematic distributions, the Governance Weekly serves as a critical tool for Accountability Lab Nepal to highlight areas where transparency and responsiveness are most urgently needed, informing targeted interventions, and furthering our mission to strengthen accountable governance systems across the country.

BACKGROUND OF STUDY

Accountability Lab Nepal has been at the forefront of promoting transparency, integrity, and good governance through citizen engagement and evidence-based advocacy. Over the past few years, Accountability Lab Nepal has expanded its efforts by collaborating with government institutions, civil society organizations, and local communities to monitor governance practices and highlight pressing accountability issues across the country. Its initiatives—such as the Governance Weekly—compile data and narratives from diverse governance domains, including elections, corruption, public service delivery, economy, and gender inclusion.

Despite the continuous efforts, understanding the magnitude and interlinkages of these issues requires systematic data analysis. The collected weekly information, while rich in qualitative and quantitative insights, often remains under-utilized without analytical visualization and trend interpretation.

Analyzing these datasets through Power BI not only enhances transparency but also helps team members and policymakers recognize key areas requiring reform. It allows for comparative evaluation of sub-issues, detection of governance bottlenecks, and identification of thematic priorities. In essence, the analysis provides a foundation for evidence-based recommendations that can further strengthen the Accountability Lab's mission to build a culture of open governance and civic trust in Nepal.

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PURPOSE OF THE STUDY

The purpose of this study is to analyze and interpret the governance-related data compiled under the Governance Weekly initiative to highlight the importance of selecting the right themes and sub-issues for deeper public understanding. Each theme, such as elections, corruption, economy, or service delivery—reflects critical aspects of governance in Nepal and examining these allows team members to grasp what kinds of news and narratives dominate during specific periods. By identifying the frequency and focus of such issues, the study aims to uncover underlying governance trends, media attention patterns, and emerging public concerns. This analytical approach, supported by visualization tools like Power BI, ensures that the data not only informs but also guides policymakers, researchers, and citizens in making informed judgments about governance priorities and accountability challenges in Nepal.

DATASET DESCRIPTION

The dataset used for this report comes from the Governance Weekly records maintained by Accountability Lab Nepal. It contains weekly entries that capture key governance-related topics reported in Nepal over a period. Each record represents a specific week, listing the main theme (such as corruption, election, economy, or education) and the related sub-issues that describe what was reported during that week.

In simple terms, the dataset serves as a collection of summarized governance news and events that help identify which issues were most frequently discussed and when they occurred. The data also includes short descriptions or “highlights” that explain the focus of each issue, such as budget changes, corruption cases, or election updates.

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Column Name	Context / Description
Week Number	Indicates the issue number of the Governance Weekly (e.g., Issue 1, Issue 2, etc.). Each issue represents a weekly edition summarizing governance-related news in Nepal.
Highlight	A concise summary of the most important or notable governance event of that week. It gives readers a snapshot of the central issue covered.
Theme	The broad category or topic that the weekly highlight falls under (e.g., Irregularity, Economy, Gender Equality, Political, etc.).
Issue 1	A detailed description or report of the first governance-related event covered in that week. Usually focuses on a specific incident, decision, or policy issue.
Theme 1	The thematic category related to Issue 1 (e.g., Health, Corruption, Election, etc.).
Issue 2	The second key issue or event discussed in the same week's publication.
Theme 2	The theme categorizes Issue 2 (e.g., Economy, Irregularity, Political, etc.).
Issue 3	The third important governance-related issue or news event covered in that week.
Theme 3	The thematic label corresponds to Issue 3 (e.g., Health, Human Rights, Others, etc.).
Issue 4	The fourth governance or policy-related issue featured in the weekly summary.
Theme 4	The theme describes Issue 4 (e.g., Migration, Service Delivery, Political, etc.).
Issue 5	The fifth governance topic or event reported in that week.
Theme 5	The associated theme for Issue 5 (commonly Economy, Election, or Irregularity).
Issue 6	The sixth governance-related article or event summarized for that week.
Theme 6	The thematic classification of Issue 6 (e.g., Education, Human Rights, Economy, etc.).

Table 1 Dataset Description

A total of 15 thematic categories, including Irregularity, Economy, Corruption, etc. are utilized. Within this structure, the "Highlight" denotes the main issue, and Issue 1 through Issue 6 denote the sub-issues associated with the respective weekly iteration.

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DISTRIBUTION ACCORDING TO THEME

S.N.	Theme Name	Count of Main Issue	Count of Sub Issue
1	Irregularity	17	63
2	Corruption	15	47
3	Economy	13	70
4	Political	12	60
5	Election	8	70
6	Environment/Climate Change	8	32
7	Human Rights	7	23
8	Education	6	32
9	Uncategorized	6	56
10	Gender Equality and Social Inclusion	5	14
11	Migration	3	13
12	Service Delivery	3	45
13	Natural Disaster	2	4
14	Health	1	35
15	Others	36	286

Table 2 Total Count of Main and Sub Issues

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SUMMARY OF THEMATIC DISTRIBUTION

The distribution of main issues and sub-issues across various themes reflects a diverse range of governance concerns in Nepal. Among all categories, “Others” holds the highest number of both main (36) and sub-issues (286), indicating that a large portion of governance discussions fall outside predefined categories, possibly representing cross-cutting or emerging issues not yet formally classified.

Economy (70 sub-issues) and Election (70 sub-issues) emerge as the most frequently discussed specific themes, highlighting the country’s ongoing focus on financial management, budget reforms, and electoral governance. These themes often reflect public interest in transparency, resource allocation, and institutional accountability during politically active periods.

Irregularity (63 sub-issues) and Political (60 sub-issues) themes also appear strongly, showing continued challenges in administrative efficiency, policy consistency, and leadership integrity. Similarly, Corruption—with 47 sub-issues—remains a persistent problem area, signaling the need for stronger oversight mechanisms and ethical governance reforms.

Themes such as Service Delivery (45 sub-issues), Health (35 sub-issues), Education (32 sub-issues), and Environment/Climate Change (32 sub-issues) demonstrate attention toward essential public sectors, yet their relatively lower counts compared to economy and politics suggest these areas receive less consistent national focus.

Smaller but significant themes like Gender Equality and Social Inclusion, Human Rights, and Migration indicate growing recognition of social justice and inclusion in governance reporting. Natural Disasters, though least frequent, underline the episodic yet impactful nature of environmental crises in Nepal.

Overall, the distribution shows that Nepal’s governance landscape is dominated by discussions on economic management, political accountability, and systemic irregularities. However, the growing diversity of themes also demonstrates an encouraging expansion of governance discourse toward inclusivity, service quality, and environmental sustainability.

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DATA VISUALIZATION INTERPRETATION

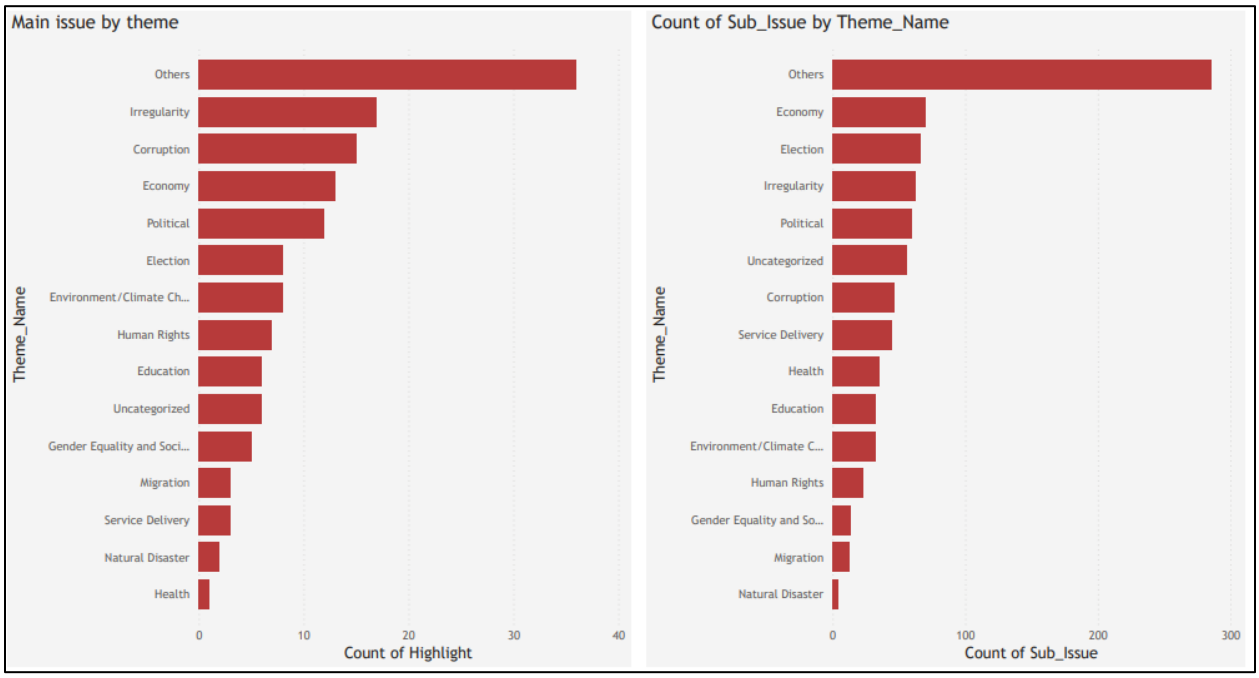

Figure 1 Main Issue (Highlight) and Sub-Issue Counts by Theme Name

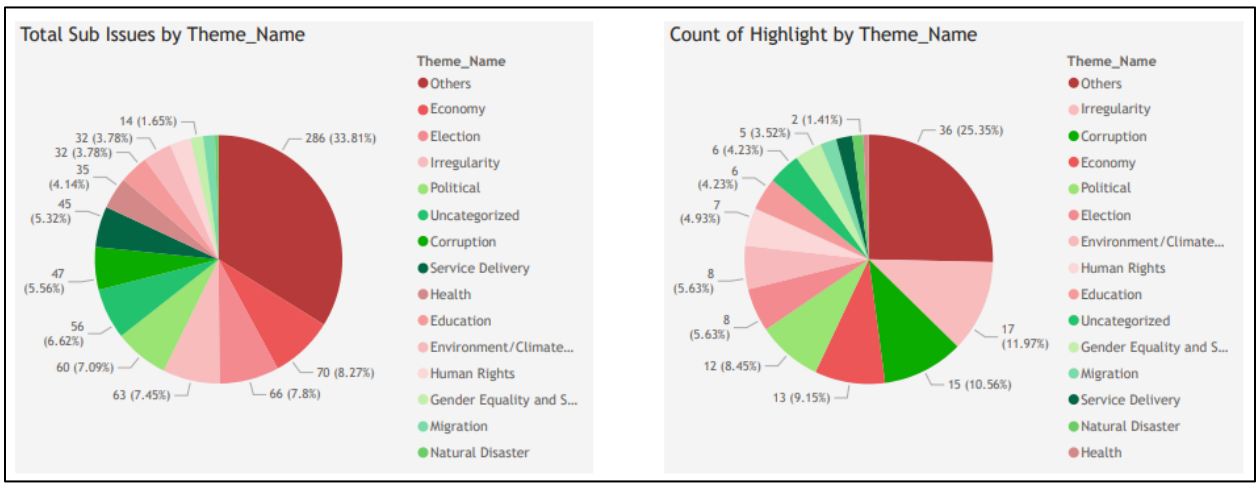

Figure 2 Distribution of Total Sub-Issues and Highlights Across All Themes

The visual analysis demonstrates clear variations across governance themes. Themes such as irregularity, economy, and political governance appear more frequently than others, showing that these areas dominate governance discourse. In contrast, themes such as education, environment, and gender equality appear less often, suggesting potential underreporting or limited media focus. Such visualization-based insights enhance the ability to track issue distribution, prioritize interventions, and monitor governance performance over time.

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REAL-TIME ABALYSIS THROUGH POWER BI

We utilize a dedicated Power BI dashboard to provide team members with comprehensive, real-time access to the complete dataset and analytical outputs. While the preceding sections of this report summarize key findings through static charts (Figures 1 and 2), the dashboard offers a dynamic, multi-page view that goes deeper into the issues.

The dashboard structure is organized to facilitate granular analysis:

1. **Overview Page:** Provides a high-level summary of the total counts for all 15 themes, including cumulative figures for Main Issues (Highlights) and Sub-Issues. This page replicates and expands upon the core visualizations presented in this report.

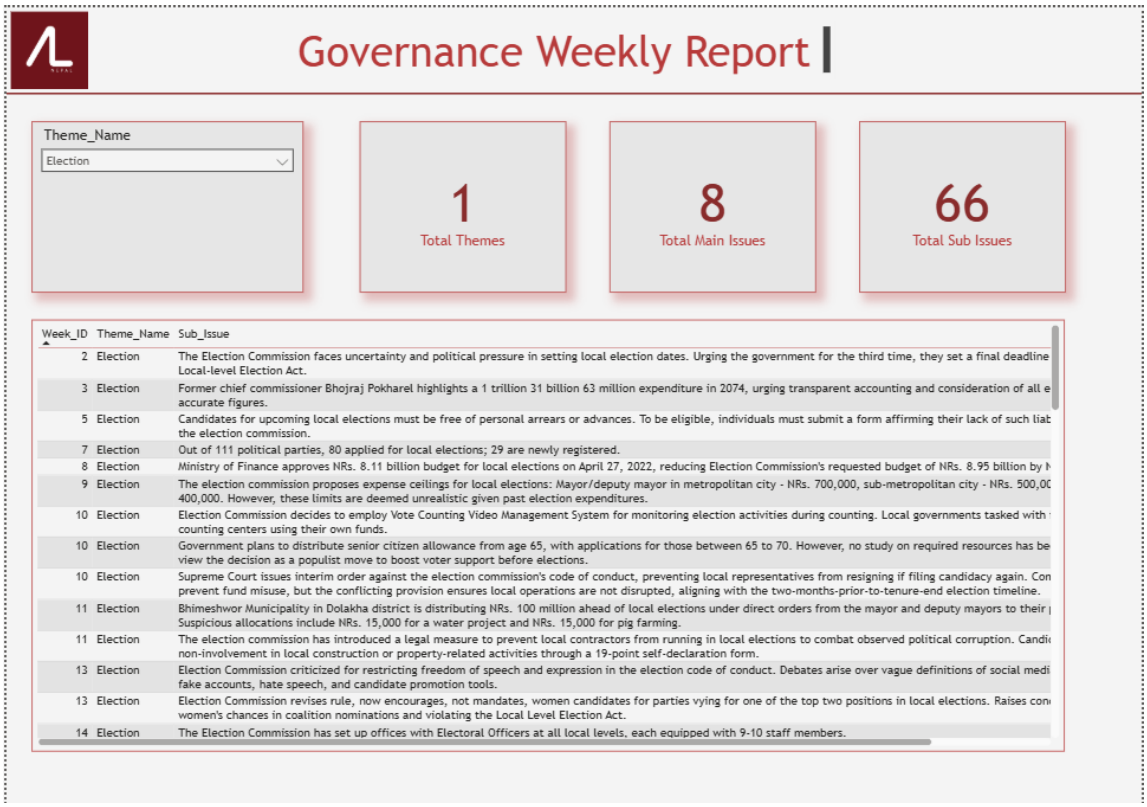

Figure 3 Overview Page

2. **Highlight Deep Dive Pages (e.g., Corruption, Economy, Election):** Dedicated pages for each of the primary themes allow users to filter and focus exclusively on the Main Issues related to that specific topic. These pages include granular tables and theme-specific metrics.

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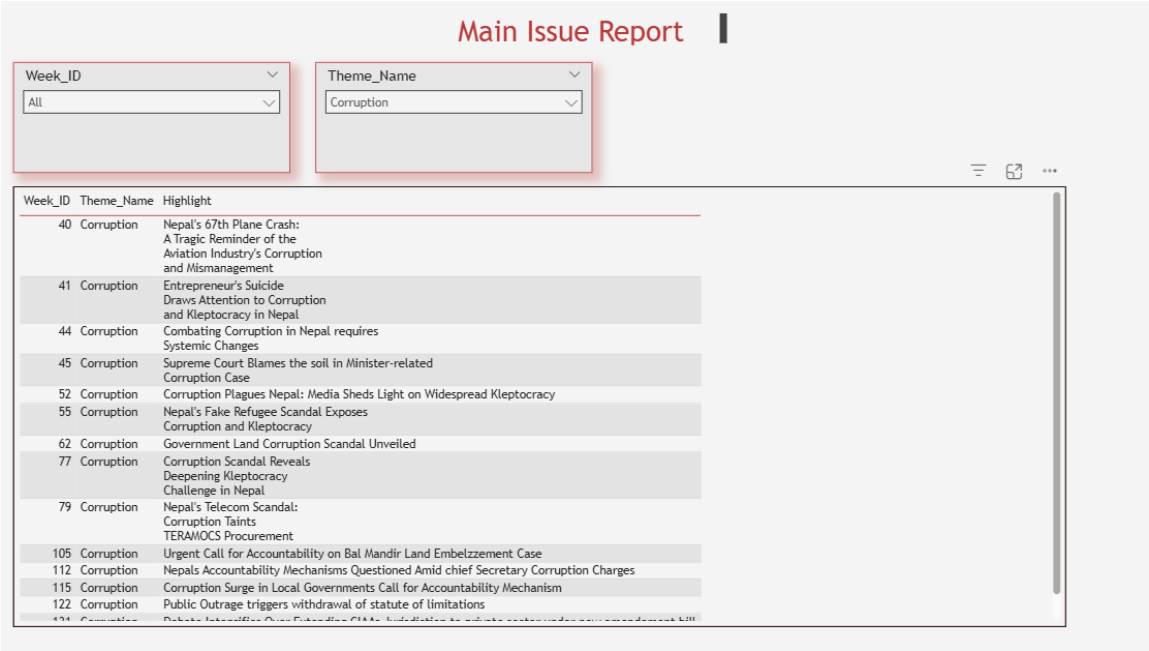

Figure 4 Main Issue Report Page

3. **Sub-Issue Detail Pages:** These pages present the full text and context of all recorded sub-issues, searchable and filterable by week, theme, and issue type. This provides the necessary qualitative context behind the quantitative trends displayed in the charts.

Figure 5 Sub Issue Report Page

4. **Trend Analysis:** Interactive visuals track the frequency of Main and Sub-Issues over time, allowing for the identification of emerging or declining trends.

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This interactive environment enables users to explore data beyond pre-selected visuals, track live updates, and drill down into the supporting evidence for every data point mentioned in this report.

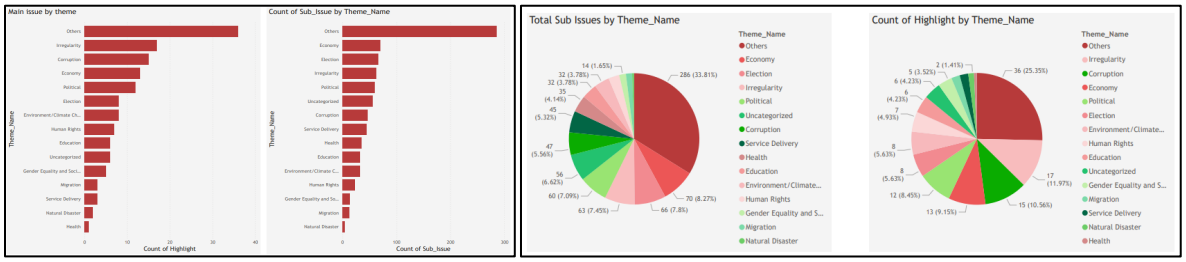

Figure 6 Trend Analysis

The complete Power BI dashboard, with all interactive tables and pages, can be accessed via the following link: **[Power BI Link]**

TREND AND COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS

The data reveals significant patterns and a critical structural challenge in the thematic distribution of governance issues.

1. Dominance of Governance and Economic Themes

A comparative look at the Count of Main Issue (Highlights) shows that Irregularity (17) and Corruption (15) are the most frequently flagged issues, aside from the ambiguous "Others" category. This suggests that the core national discourse is driven by concerns over administrative ethics and integrity.

In terms of total thematic impact, Sub-Issue Counts reveal a few dominant themes:

- Economic Management: Economy (70) and Election (70) share the top rank for specific issue counts. This suggests public scrutiny is highly focused on financial allocation, budgetary transparency, and the fiscal processes associated with major events like elections.
- Political Stability and Order: Irregularity (63) and Political (60) issues follow closely, indicating a consistent challenge with policy implementation, political conduct, and state functionality.

2. Low Focus on Essential Public Services

While themes like Service Delivery (45), Health (35), Education (32), and Environment/Climate Change (32) represent critical public sectors, their relatively lower presence in the issue counts indicates they receive less consistent attention compared to

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the dominant political and economic narratives. This suggests a potential pattern of reactive reporting on essential services rather than continuous, proactive scrutiny.

3. The Structural Problem of the "Others" Category

The single most significant data pattern is the disproportionate volume of content grouped under "Others":

- Main Issues: 36 (25.35% of all Highlights)
- Sub-Issues: 286 (33.81% of all Sub-Issues)

This volume is larger than the next three specific themes combined and distorts the apparent trends and focus areas of the entire analysis. This category creates a trend ambiguity, as over a third of the collected sub-issues are not properly distinguished or classified. While the Trend Analysis page in the Power BI dashboard can track the frequency of this "Others" category over time, it fundamentally obscures the true nature of the emerging or cross-cutting issues, hindering effective pattern recognition and targeted policy interventions.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Based on the thematic distribution and the structural challenges identified, the following recommendations are crucial for enhancing the analytical quality and actionability of future reports:

1. Refine Thematic Classification

The "Others" (286 sub-issues) and "Uncategorized" (56 sub-issues) columns represent a critical failure in thematic distinction.

- Action: Conduct a deep-dive qualitative review of the content within the "Others" category. This review must lead to the creation of three to five new, distinct thematic categories (e.g., *Infrastructure*, *Foreign Policy*, *Cybersecurity*, or *Lax Enforcement*) to better classify these emerging issues.
- Impact: By properly classifying this content, the true patterns currently hidden will be revealed, leading to more accurate trend analysis and focused policy decisions.

2. Prioritize Main Issue Monitoring

The concentration of Main Issues in Irregularity (17) and Corruption (15) suggests that these themes are the highest-priority policy pressure points.

- Action: Utilize the Power BI dashboard’s Highlight Deep Dive Pages (Figure 4) not just for viewing, but for actively monitoring these specific themes weekly. Focus

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intervention strategies and reform efforts on addressing the systemic roots of corruption and irregularity.

CONCLUSION

The thematic distribution confirms that Nepal's governance discourse is currently dominated by high-level concerns regarding political accountability, administrative integrity, and economic governance. The high volume of sub-issues related to Economy and Election establishes these areas as persistent centers of public and media scrutiny.

However, the analysis is fundamentally undermined by the massive, ambiguous volume of content captured under the "Others" category. This structural mistake obscures critical emerging trends and prevents accurate pattern analysis, making it difficult to confidently conclude where governance attention should be redirected.

To transition from mere data reporting to effective, actionable intelligence, it is imperative to address this classification gap. By refining the thematic structure and fully leveraging the real-time, multi-page capabilities of the Power BI dashboard, the monitoring system can move beyond reflecting general trends and begin providing precise, evidence-based direction for governance reforms. The future effectiveness of this report hinges on the commitment to making the "Others" truly distinguishable.

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